

Mrs. Rasmussen | ESL 1 Class Syllabus

English as a Second Language | Grades 4-8 | Mary, Star of the Sea School

School Year 2026-2027

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Welcome Parents and Guardians!

I am Mrs. Rasmussen, your child's English as a Second Language teacher. I am a graduate of the University of Hawaii with a Bachelor's in Secondary Education / Social Studies and a minor in Psychology. I have additional coursework in Montessori and Early Childhood Development and am certified to teach preschool through grade 12.

I have spent years substituting in public schools, an orthopedic unit, a deaf and blind school, and special education. I also spent 10 years at Star of the Sea Early Learning Center in preschool and kindergarten. I have tutored students in various subjects since 1978 and have been an ESL teacher at Mary, Star of the Sea since 2006.

I am here to facilitate your child's learning of English as well as support their functioning in the regular classroom. In ESL 1, we work on speaking and oral reading; we write weekly on a variety of topics; and we learn vocabulary words and their usage.

Communication among teachers, students, and parents is essential in learning English. I am grateful for your support and the opportunity to work with your child.

Sincerely,

Mrs. Rasmussen | drasmussen@starofthesea.org

Our Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

- **Language Arts** - Parts of speech and sentence structure.
- **Reading Skills** - Facts, Sequence, Context, Main Idea, Conclusion, and Inference.
- **Writing Skills** - Personal narratives, informative writing, descriptive writing, opinion and comparative writing, stories, and short reports.

English as a Second Language - Scope

- **I. Communication:** Oral and written communication; understanding directions; listening and following directions.
- **II. Vocabulary & Grammar Usage:** Parts of speech; writing in complete sentences; mechanics.
- **III. Reading:** Decoding words; punctuation; intonation; fluency.
- **IV. Comprehension:** Understanding directions and questions; responding in complete sentences; context clues; main idea; noting details; cause and effect; predicting outcomes; inferences; drawing conclusions.
- **V. Writing:** Sentences, questions, and answers; short answers, paragraphs, essays; different forms of writing.

Homework & Support at Home

- **Homework** - Assigned daily, about 20 minutes of independent work. Due when the next class is in session.

- Computers and other tools such as dictionaries are allowed.
- I encourage the use of English in the home daily.
- **Reading aloud** - 20 minutes each day helps students speak English clearly and write in complete sentences.
- Students who need assistance completing assignments may finish their work during lunch recess in my room.

"Let's work together for a successful year!"

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith